CASE STUDY

Feedback is the filter: an AI talent pipeline where every applicant gets an answer

Find the best candidates for a job description, filter out the weakest, and never leave anyone wondering whether anyone looked. Every applicant gets a score and specific advice, and what they do with it shows who is worth your time.

Run by one person | Personal details kept from the model | A person approves the last 10%

At a glance

Over 300 applications a year	**Over 30** candidates interviewed a year	**8** placed a year, writing production code	**5** of the first interns have moved on to full-time roles

All figures are annual. The pipeline has been in production for over a year, for an intern program that places students in software roles. The same method works for any role you can describe in writing.

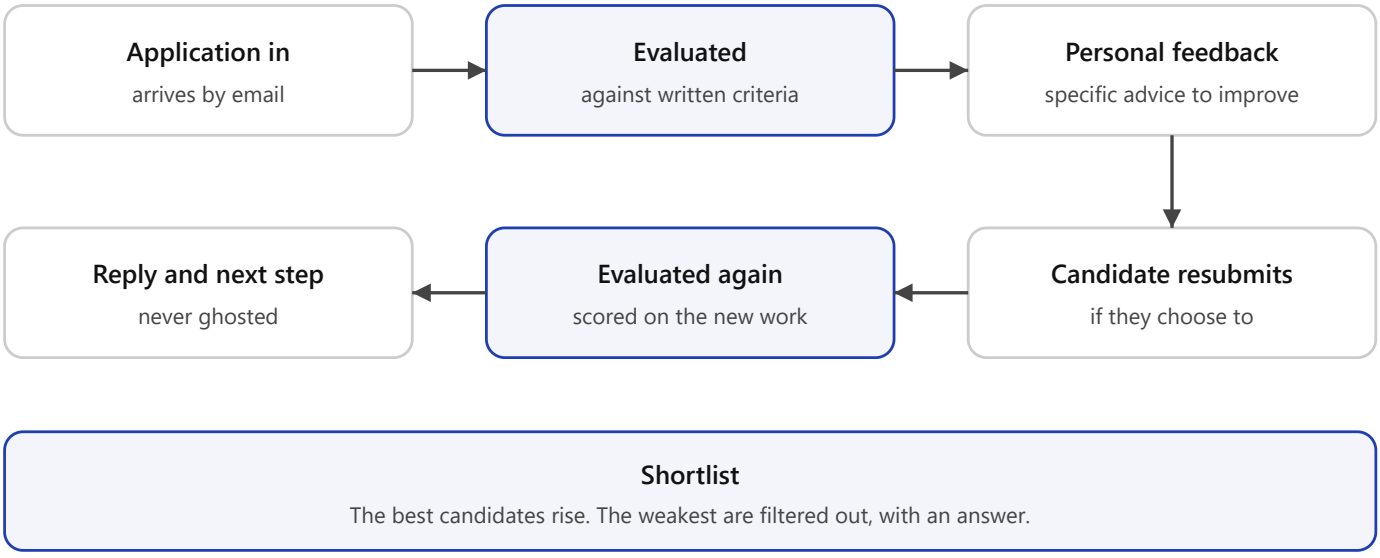
The problem

You have a job description and a pile of applications. You do not have time to read them all, and you are not a recruiter. You want the strongest candidates at the top and the weakest filtered out. You also do not want to ghost anyone, because a rejection with no feedback tells a candidate that nobody looked.

Doing both by hand does not scale. Doing the first part with a keyword filter does it badly, and throws away people who are good but phrase things differently.

How it works

Built as a development pipeline, not a filter. Nobody is ghosted. Every applicant gets a reply, a score and specific advice, and can come back.



- Applications and CVs are read and scored against criteria written down in advance.
- Where candidates share code, it is pulled and reviewed too. Over 50 code reviews, and over 100 candidates scored and filed.
- A personal reply is drafted with the score and the specific things to work on.
- A resubmission is scored again, on the new work.

Feedback is the filter

Specific feedback is also a free test of motivation. Everyone is offered the same chance to improve, and what they do with it tells you something a CV cannot.



Over half of the candidates came back at least once, and some came back several times. The ones who did show more than skill: they want it, and they work for it.

I do not claim that candidates got better. I have not measured that. The signal is the effort, and it is cheap to get.

What the reply looks like

Hi [redacted]

We've reviewed the repository you provided. You have built a comprehensive full-stack application [redacted] using modern technologies like .NET 9, React, and Azure, demonstrating strong capabilities in both backend and frontend development, including CI/CD. Your experience with C#/.NET in a professional setting and SQL is also a significant positive.

Your application places well within the pool. While the [redacted] project is well-structured, it represents a single-service application, and there's an opportunity to demonstrate experience with more complex distributed system architectures.

On the repository specifically:

To further improve your position in the applicant pool, we suggest the following improvments:

- Deepen your understanding and application of advanced architectural patterns, such as microservices or event-driven architectures, beyond a single monolithic API.
- Explore more complex data modeling and database optimization techniques, especially for high-volume or distributed data scenarios.
- Implement comprehensive error handling, logging, and monitoring within your applications to demonstrate robustness in production environments.

If you do make those or any other changes, be sure to resubmit and we will re-evaluate your application.

A drafted reply to an applicant. It says what was reviewed, where the application sits in the pool, three specific things to work on, and that a resubmission will be evaluated again. Names are blacked out.

Safe with people's data

- **Personal details never reach the model.** Scoring does not need a name, an address or a photo, so they are stripped before anything is evaluated. The evaluation is GDPR-compliant by design, and it is also fairer.
- **Every applicant is told by email that AI is used.** Nobody finds out later.
- **A person is in the loop for the last 10%.** About 90% of the process is automated. That figure is my estimate. A person approves replies and decisions before they go out.

Your criteria, not mine

The scoring criteria are written down, not buried in code. Pointing the pipeline at a different job description, with different must-haves and a different weighting, is a configuration change, not a rebuild. It has run for one intern program so far. I have not run it for another business, and I am not claiming I have.

One person, and what that replaced

One person runs the pipeline, and it has been in production for over a year. The earlier version of this program, run by hand at another organization, took three people four years to place 6 to 8 students a year. This is not a controlled comparison: a different organization, a different intake. I put it here as context, not as the point. The point is that every applicant gets an answer and the best ones are easy to find.

What I do not know yet

- Whether candidates who resubmit actually get better. I measure whether they come back, not how much they improved.
- The cost against the manual process. I have not worked it out.
- The 90% automated figure is an estimate, not a measurement.

Where it is now

It runs today. If you screen many people, want the best at the top and want the rest to hear back, get in touch.

Terms: AI candidate screening, talent pipeline, AI automation, human in the loop, applicant feedback, GDPR, data minimization, code review, shortlisting.

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Case study v0.1, 1 November 2026. Names and branding removed. No tracking and no outside scripts.